

Like Split/Sybil/etc.?

No. These (and similar) depictions of DID/plurality are deeply harmful and misleading.

Isn't that, like, super rare?

Not really. There's not much info on the prevalence of plurality overall, but studies suggest ~1-2% of the population has DID, which is more common than it sounds. On top of that, DID systems are only a fraction of the plural community.

Am I plural?

Maybe? This is like asking "Am I gay?". Plurality is often less obvious than it sounds. Figuring that out usually requires questioning, self-reflection, time, and community interaction.

How can I learn more?

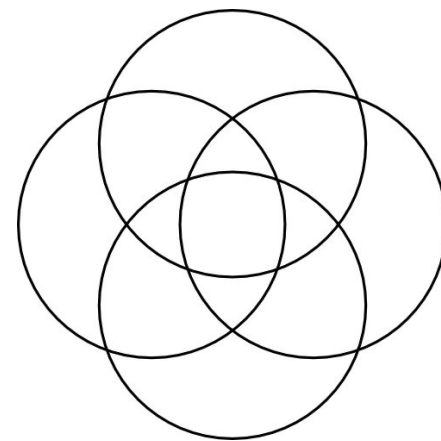
Stay tuned for more of our zines! We'll be answering questions you send in and showcasing plural experiences. Also, listening to systems and organizations such as the Plural Association.

Ask-A-System

Have any questions?

Send them to:
thefencerhivemind@gmail.com

We'll do our best to answer them in upcoming zine issues!



What is Plurality?

The Fencer Hivemind

How/why do systems exist?

It varies system-to-system. Scientific studies show disordered forms are almost always caused by trauma, but there are very few studies into non-disordered plurality. For some systems, it's just the way they've always been. Some systems became plural by training their brains to think as separate people. Some systems have spiritual beliefs about their plurality. For some systems, it's some combination of the above.

FAQ

So, like DID?

Sort of. DID is a form of plurality, but it's far from the only one. There are other disorders similar to DID, (such as OSDD-1, DDNOS, and P-DID), and not all systems are disordered. For something to be a disorder, it has to cause distress/dysfunction. This separates identities (like being gay) from disorders. For many systems, being plural is like being gay, not a medical issue.

Common Plural Terms

System– A group of people/identities sharing a body and brain.
Single– Someone who is not plural.
Headmate– An individual member of a plural system.
Front/fronting– Being aware/in control of the body.
Headspace– An internal space created by a system where headmates go when not fronting.

What is Plurality?

Plurality is the state of having more than one person or identity in a single brain and body. The plural community is very diverse, including systems with a wide range of origins and ways of functioning. This zine serves as an overview of the most common/general terms and experiences. Individual systems may have preferences that differ from what is described here.